

Tapping New Talent in the FOSS Domain!

Industry experts share their views on what's holding back raw IT talent from exploring the world of FOSS and what could be done to attract it.



Businesses in India are waking up to the potential of Free and Open Source Software (FOSS) as a sustainable and robust revenue model, and that explains the large-scale open source software deployments across varied verticals. While the open source ecosystem has redefined the Indian enterprise IT market, the big question is: Is there enough FOSS talent in India? Or are there too many bottlenecks within the ecosystem that are stopping the raw IT talent from exploring the world of FOSS?

Most FOSS advocates and industry experts believe that though open source adoption in the Indian IT landscape is growing at a rapid pace, there are quite a few stumbling

blocks that are impeding the development of a steadfast FOSS ecosystem and, in turn, failing to attract the raw IT talent into this open domain. K C Ramakrishna, CEO and founder of R-Knowsys Technologies, a premier FOSS enabler and provider in Hyderabad, shares, "Contributing to FOSS involves a reasonable amount of investment in terms of time and effort. Indian developers (even most international developers) do not see the benefit of such an investment. Will their salaries improve as a result? Unfortunately, not. Only product-based firms and high tech companies value those skills. Most consulting firms do not care about them. Unfortunately, most developers in India do not know how